

Christopher Amen Kola

Software Engineer

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[Open-Source Contributor on PyPI](#) | [100+ Docker Hub Pulls \(CommitGen CLI\)](#) | [WeThinkCode_ Alumnus](#)

SUMMARY

Full-stack software engineer who genuinely loves building things that work well and ship fast. I'm a generalist at heart, strong across both frontend and backend with Java, Python, JavaScript, and React, but I lean towards backend development, CI/CD pipelines, and cloud infrastructure on AWS. I've shipped a WhatsApp automation bot that handles ~1,000 messages a day for a real client, published an open-source CLI tool to PyPI and Docker Hub, and mentored the next cohort of developers at WeThinkCode_. I'm an AI-forward developer, I use LLMs and AI tooling daily to move faster without cutting corners on quality. I'm at my best in a team: pair programming, honest code reviews, and building something bigger than what any one person could do alone.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Java (primary), Python, JavaScript/Node.js, Bash
- **Backend & Frameworks:** Spring Boot, Javalin, Express.js, React, Django
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Bedrock, IAM, Amplify), Docker, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions
- **Testing & Methods:** TDD, JUnit, pytest, Agile/Scrum, Pair Programming
- **Data & Networking:** SQL, ORM, DynamoDB, TCP/UDP, HTTP, DNS, REST APIs

EXPERIENCE

Freelance WhatsApp Automation Developer (Freelance Contract)

Blossom Blooms | Remote | May 2025 – Jan 2026

- Built and maintained a WhatsApp chatbot handling ~1,000 automated messages/day, cutting the client's manual response workload by roughly 90%.
- Designed intelligent routing and automated product link distribution using Node.js, Python, and the Baileys WhatsApp API.
- Achieved zero-downtime availability by self-hosting with Ngrok tunneling and proactive monitoring.

Bootcamp Mentor & Python Workshop Facilitator

WeThinkCode_ | Johannesburg | Aug – Oct 2025

- Taught Python fundamentals, debugging techniques, and CLI tooling to incoming bootcamp cohorts.
- Guided learners through algorithmic challenges and Linux/dev environment setup, building their independence as developers.
- Reviewed candidate submissions and wrote structured evaluations for the selection process.

HPE Software Engineering Job Simulation

Hewlett Packard Enterprise (Forage) | Jan 2026

- Built a RESTful Spring Boot service for employee record management, passing all endpoint integration tests.
- Achieved 100% test coverage on core business logic with JUnit, validating behaviour across all service endpoints.

PROJECTS

CommitGen — AI-Powered Git CLI Tool

Python, Docker, OpenAI API, GitHub Actions | github.com/Ckola99/commit-gen

Published on PyPI | 100+ Docker Hub pulls | Multi-stage Docker builds | CI/CD to PyPI + Docker Hub

- Developed a CLI tool that analyses staged Git diffs and generates Conventional Commit messages using OpenAI's API.
- Containerised with multi-stage Docker builds and automated dual deployment via GitHub Actions.

Brownfields Robot Worlds Platform — Distributed Systems

Java, Docker, TCP, SQL, GitLab CI/CD | github.com/Ckola99/Robot-worlds-brownfields

- Modernised a legacy TCP robot-control system into a modular layered architecture with a Javalin REST API.

- Containerised all services and automated Docker image building/publishing via GitLab CI/CD pipelines.

AWS CloudFunFacts Generator — Serverless Application

AWS Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Bedrock, Python | github.com/Ckola99/CloudFunFacts

Live: production.d11q6mprl0gz9y.amplifyapp.com

- Deployed a fully serverless app end-to-end: API Gateway to Lambda to DynamoDB, with optional AI enhancement via AWS Bedrock.
- Automated DynamoDB provisioning and data seeding with boto3 and AWS CLI, configured IAM policies and CORS.

Audiophile E-Commerce Website — Full-Featured React Storefront

React, Redux, Tailwind CSS, React Hook Form, React Router | github.com/Ckola99/Ecom-site

Live: ecom-site-five.vercel.app

- Built a multi-page e-commerce storefront with product browsing, cart management, and a full checkout flow including form validation with Yup schemas.
- Implemented Redux for global state management with localStorage persistence, keeping cart contents intact across browser sessions.
- Optimised for performance and SEO with responsive mobile-first design, dynamic meta tags via React Helmet, and Lighthouse-driven improvements.

Kanban Task Management App — React SPA

React, JavaScript, Tailwind CSS, Redux | github.com/Ckola99/Kanban-webapp

Live: kanban-web.vercel.app

- Built a responsive task-management dashboard with real-time status tracking and categorised board views.
- Implemented Redux for global state management with localStorage persistence and a pomodoro focus mode.

Aletheia — Algorithmic Forex Trading Engine (ICT Methodology)

Java 21, Spring Boot, Maven (multi-module), TimescaleDB, Redis, Docker, Prometheus/Grafana, OANDA v3 API | github.com/Ckola99/aletheia-hft

- Architected a multi-module trading engine implementing the ICT (Inner Circle Trader) methodology as deterministic, test-driven code — spanning live market data ingestion, price-structure detection, risk-managed execution, and full backtesting.
- Built a five-pillar signal-aggregation system (USD Index bias, killzone timing, economic-news filtering, higher-timeframe price arrays, and liquidity-sweep detection) with cross-pair SMT-divergence confirmation for trade-grade scoring.
- Validated the strategy against a full year of historical tick data on EUR/USD and GBP/USD, achieving Profit Factors of 1.90 and 1.65 respectively with realistic spread simulation and zero look-ahead bias.
- Engineered production-style safeguards — circuit breakers, an emergency kill switch, and order-expiry logic — alongside Prometheus/Grafana observability, containerised via Docker Compose with TimescaleDB and Redis.
- Drove development test-first with 240+ unit and integration tests (JUnit 5, AssertJ) covering every signal detector and execution path.

EDUCATION

WeThinkCode_ | Johannesburg, South Africa

Diploma in Software Engineering (Full-Stack) — NQF Level 6

Feb 2025 – May 2026

University of the Witwatersrand | Johannesburg, South Africa

BSc Electrical and Information Engineering (196 credits completed) - Incomplete

2018 – 2022

Marist Brothers Linmeyer | Johannesburg, South Africa

National Senior Certificate (NSC)

2009 – 2017